



YOU ARE PLAYING

Devon Ashby

Gala Party Planner

“Seating plans, sparkles and a schedule timed to the minute.”



FOR DEVON ASHBY'S EYES ONLY

Do not share this booklet. Do not read ahead of the rounds.

COSTUME IDEA

A sparkly top, a headset or clipboard, and a fistful of party poppers.

WHAT EVERYONE KNOWS ABOUT YOU

Larkhaven's go-to party planner for three years. Devon organised every minute of tonight's gala, from the running order to the photo booth.

- ◆ **Ellis Pendleworth:** your host, and the gala's guest of honour
- ◆ **Parker Brightwell:** the mayor whose office hired you
- ◆ **Harper Lune:** a newcomer who helped you tie the party favours this evening

PAGE 2

Before the game

Read before guests arrive

PAGE 3

Rounds 1 · 2

Read each only when told

PAGE 4

Round 3 · Notes

Suspects & your theories

Turn the page only when you are ready to begin. Detective Rowan Hale will tell you when to read each round.



Before the game



THE TRUTH · KEEP IT HIDDEN

You are the culprit. You put Ellis's own sleeping drops into their cocoa. Nobody else knows.

Your background

Your party business is sinking in debt. For three years you have quietly padded the invoices you send the town, just to stay afloat.

YOUR SECRET

This year you billed the town for 400 fireworks but bought only 150. Yesterday Ellis found out from the fireworks crew and wrote you a letter: Ellis would tell the Mayor tonight, right after the announcement. At 7:00, while setting up the workshop, you asked Avery Vale about the little brown bottle on the shelf (Ellis's sleeping drops) and later slipped it into your bag. At 10:02 you wrote a kitchen slip for Ellis's cocoa, emptied the drops into the blue mug and carried it in at 10:05. You chatted until Ellis drifted off, tied the mantel clock's pendulum with gold favour ribbon and turned the hands back to 9:42, when you were on stage for the raffle. You left at 10:20 and hid the empty bottle in your padlocked supply crate.

Your cover story

You were in the kitchen from 10:00 to 10:25 refilling the punch, and you never went into the workshop after the raffle. The stopped clock "proves" Ellis collapsed at 9:42, while everyone could see you on stage. You may lie about all of this. Do not confess until Detective Rowan Hale reads the solution.

Your goals tonight

- ◆ Keep suspicion pointed well away from you
- ◆ Keep the fireworks bill quiet
- ◆ Win Best Bluffer without anyone guessing why

HOW THIS BOOKLET WORKS

- ◆ Page 3 holds Rounds 1 and 2; page 4 holds Round 3. Read each round **only when Detective Rowan Hale announces it**.
- ◆ Print this booklet **single-sided** so later rounds never show through. You can also cut along the dashed line on page 3 and hand out the rounds one at a time.
- ◆ Share what your round tells you to share. Everything on this page stays secret unless a round says otherwise.

Rounds 1 and 2



✦ Round 1



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 1.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ Keep the party running: you are the planner, after all!
- ◆ Point at the stopped clock: 9:42 is when Ellis must have collapsed, and you were on stage for the raffle in front of everyone.
- ◆ From the stage you saw Reese Calloway slip into the workshop at 9:40. Make sure people hear it.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Reese Calloway** what they were doing in the workshop at 9:40.
- ◆ Ask **Harper Lune** why a stranger turned up on the very day of the announcement.

YOUR TASK

Get three people to agree out loud that the stopped clock shows when Ellis collapsed.

----- ✂ FOLD OR CUT HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE -----

✦ Round 2



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 2.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ About the kitchen slip (E6): yes, you wrote it, because Ellis asked for cocoa. Claim you left the mug on the corridor table for Ellis to collect, where anyone could reach it.
- ◆ If Emerson Quill says you went in: say you popped in for a moment to check the announcement time, nothing more.
- ◆ Point at the silver pillbox (E5): Harper Lune carries sleep tablets!

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Emerson Quill** why they sat outside the workshop door for so long.
- ◆ Ask **Avery Vale** whether they had been hoping to receive Old Lark's keys.

YOUR TASK

Quietly convince one player that Harper Lune's pillbox explains everything.

Round 3 and notes



✦ Round 3



Read only when Detective Rowan Hale starts Round 3.

REVEAL OR SHARE

- ◆ About the bottle in your crate (E10): the crate stood open in the kitchen all night, so anyone could have dropped it in.
- ◆ About the gold ribbon (E11): every party favour in the room has that ribbon, so anyone could have used one.
- ◆ About the letter (E8): if you must, admit the fireworks “mix-up”. Call it a supplier error you meant to fix.

ASK

- ◆ Ask **Avery Vale** why they were the one who “found” Ellis.
- ◆ Ask **Parker Brightwell** whether the museum plan was worth a quarrel.

YOUR TASK

Steer at least one player to accuse someone else, and fill in your own ballot accusing someone else too.

Notes

Suspects at a glance

Avery Vale · Apprentice Clockmaker

Reese Calloway · Rival Watchmaker from the City

Harper Lune · The Clockmaker’s Long-Lost Relative

Kit Sterling · Antique Dealer

Rory Penhallow · Keeper of the Clock Tower

Dakota Fenwick · Fireworks Master

Parker Brightwell · Mayor of Larkhaven

Emerson Quill · Reporter, The Larkhaven Ledger

Devon Ashby · Gala Party Planner

Sage Whitfield · Gala Pianist & Bandleader

Blair Okafor · Town Historian

Marley Ashgrove · Society Photographer